

L3 Learning Journal

Pillar	Learning	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	15 minutes setup, then 5 minutes daily	Group Size	Individual (with optional team sharing)
Mode	Solo (manager self-work or individual practice)	Format	Any
Prerequisites	None	CLOVER ERA Trigger	No culture of continuous learning, learning not embedded in daily workflow, fear of failure in learning, low engagement in learning programs

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

The brain's default mode network (DMN) processes and consolidates learning during periods of reflection. Without deliberate reflection, learning experiences pass through working memory and are rapidly forgotten. The forgetting curve (Ebbinghaus) shows that without reinforcement, 70% of new information is lost within 24 hours.

Writing activates different neural circuits than thinking alone. The act of putting learning into words forces the brain to organise, categorise, and connect new information to existing knowledge. This process, called elaborative encoding, substantially increases retention and the ability to apply learning in new contexts.

The Exercise

Phase 1: Setup (15 minutes, once)

Choose a format (physical notebook, digital note, app). The format matters less than the habit. Provide three daily prompts:

DAILY JOURNAL PROMPTS

1. What did I learn today? (A skill, a piece of information, something about a colleague, something about myself)
2. Where did I struggle today? (Not to dwell on it, but to identify where growth is happening)
3. What will I do differently tomorrow based on today? (One specific thing, not a general aspiration)

The third prompt is the most important. It converts reflection into action. Without it, the journal becomes a diary rather than a learning tool.

Phase 2: Weekly Review (10 minutes, weekly)

Once a week, read the week's entries. Look for patterns: recurring struggles (same gap showing up?), progress on priority skills, connections between different learning moments. Write one sentence summarising the week's most important learning.

Phase 3: Team Sharing (optional, 5 minutes in team meeting)

WHAT TO SAY

"Who has a learning insight from this week they'd be willing to share? Not a polished lesson. Something you noticed, something that surprised you, something you're still figuring out."

Keep this voluntary and brief. The goal is to normalise continuous learning as visible team behaviour, not to create a performance obligation.

Facilitation Notes

Situation	Response
People stop after a week	The habit fails most often because 5 minutes feels like 'one more thing.' Anchor it to an existing routine: "Do it in the last 5 minutes before you close your laptop for the day." Habit stacking (attaching a new habit to an existing one) is the most reliable behaviour change technique.
Entries become performative ("I learned that teamwork is important")	Push for specificity: "What specifically about teamwork? What moment today showed you something about how you or someone else collaborates?" Generic entries produce no learning. Specific entries produce insight.

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
R1: Micro-Reflection	L3 is a learning-specific reflection practice. R1 provides broader reflection prompts. They can share the same daily habit slot.	Complementary (combine or alternate)
L1: Skills Diagnostic	Journal entries often surface skill gaps that the L1 diagnostic missed.	L3 feeds back into L1 over time
V2: Failure Stories	The 'where did I struggle' prompt builds the self-awareness that makes V2's failure	Complementary

	sharing more genuine.	
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